

Cassie Kesterholt

CPTM · sPHR · 10+ Years Progressive HR, Talent Development & Organizational Development

I build scalable people programs that make managers' lives easier and employees' experiences better. Over 10+ years of progressive experience in people-focused roles, I have led company-wide performance management, talent reviews, compensation planning, career development, and manager enablement programs while serving as a trusted advisor to executive leaders. I report directly to the CHRO and lead a team of 15 across the US and Mexico. I move seamlessly between strategy and execution: one day partnering with executives on organizational design, the next refining core people processes or coaching managers through complexity. I leverage AI and automation to optimize people systems, having built three enterprise AI agents with 82% adoption across 1,650+ employees. I thrive in high-growth environments where building from the ground up is the expectation, not the exception.

Location

Dallas, TX (Remote)

Email

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LinkedIn

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Current Role

Director, Talent Development, OneCall

Director, Talent Development

Aug 2025 – Present

OneCall, Jacksonville, FL (Remote)

- Developed scalable manager enablement programs, tools, and resources: designed a company-wide leadership development program from scratch covering performance conversations, people leadership, and manager effectiveness. Delivered training to 500+ leaders totaling 1,000+ training hours in 2024 alone.
- Stood up the company's first formal talent management strategy — 9-box calibration, succession planning, and structured career pathways — giving leadership real data to make development decisions and strengthening bench depth across the enterprise.
- Currently leading people operations integration for OneCall's acquisition of Data Dimensions, including leadership assessment, talent retention, cultural integration, and workforce readiness. Previously built the M&A talent integration playbook from scratch during an earlier acquisition, partnering with executive leadership to align talent practices and keep disruption low and retention high.
- Launched talent infrastructure for a new site in Monterrey, MX from scratch — building bilingual onboarding, training programs, and development systems in a market we had never operated in before.
- Drive strategic People initiatives that improve engagement, retention, and manager effectiveness: executive sponsor for 4 Employee Resource Groups and enterprise DEI strategy. A collaborative, low-ego approach with willingness to roll up sleeves.
- Built "Dev," an enterprise LLM chatbot now used by 1,650+ employees for career development — it guides people through IDP-based reflection on their strengths, growth areas, and aspirations on their own terms. Also built a DEIB chatbot that helps manage and activate insights across 4 Employee Resource Groups. Nobody asked for these to be built; the opportunity was there, so it happened. Also oversee a self-paced training catalog of 43+ modules accessed by 3,000+ colleagues annually.
- Report directly to the CHRO. Mentor and elevate a growing People team of 15 across the US and Mexico, delivering 13,000+ training hours annually. Analyze People metrics and trends to identify opportunities and recommend solutions. Reduced new hire turnover from 43% to 25% through data-driven program redesign.

Senior Manager, People Development

Apr 2024 – Aug 2025

OneCall, Jacksonville, FL (Remote)

- Owned the strategy and execution of enterprise-wide talent programs — performance management, employee engagement, leadership development — during a period where the company was evolving fast and the playbook was being written in real time.
- Designed and implemented a 9-box succession planning framework to guide talent calibration and growth pathways.
- Built and refined enterprise competency models that translate organizational values into specific, actionable development plans for leaders at every level — connecting the work people do every day to where the company is headed.
- Served as a trusted advisor to leaders across the business, coaching managers through employee relations, performance conversations, and leadership challenges. Balanced employee advocacy with business needs.
- Navigated ambiguity and built programs from the ground up, moving between long-term strategy and immediate execution needs with resilience and flexibility.

Enterprise Learning Manager

Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

OneCall, Jacksonville, FL (Remote)

- Developed and executed comprehensive enterprise learning programs to improve employee capabilities and support evolving business needs.
- Partnered with department leaders to assess skill gaps, design role-based training pathways, and drive adoption of learning management systems (Cornerstone).
- Redesigned new hire orientation, reducing time spent in orientation by 4 hours while improving effectiveness. Oriented 460+ new hires across 38 sessions annually.

Head of Operations

Apr 2020 – Mar 2023

Wedfully, Denver, CO

- Built the entire People function from zero at a high-growth, venture-backed startup: talent acquisition, training, performance management, and workforce planning for a 100% remote national workforce. There was no playbook to follow, so it got written from scratch.
- Scaled a 100% contract-based workforce to support national event execution, improving margin per client by 25%.
- Built the people and operational infrastructure that let the company scale nationally — which ultimately contributed to an appearance on CBS's Shark Tank.
- Created internal training systems, performance review processes, and documentation for scalable onboarding. Team training initiatives resolved a \$5M annual cost issue and saved \$150K by addressing a compliance gap that retained a key provider.
- Led HRIS operations and partnered with leadership on organizational policies, compensation structures, and employee engagement strategy.

Member Success Manager, People Development

May 2017 – May 2019

Galvanize, Denver, CO

Managed member success, employee engagement, and professional development programming for a tech education community.

Head of Operations and People

Oct 2015 – Apr 2017

Havenly, Denver, CO

Led people operations, talent acquisition, performance management, and organizational development for a venture-backed startup.

SKILLS & TOOLS

HRIS / HCM

- Workday
- UKG
- BambooHR
- Cornerstone LMS
- Rippling
- Salesforce

ATS

- Greenhouse
- Lever

LEARNING

- LinkedIn Learning
- Articulate / Rise

ENGAGEMENT / PERFORMANCE

- Qualtrics
- 15Five
- McLean & Company

AI

- Microsoft Copilot Studio
- Prompt Engineering
- RAG
- Claude
- ChatGPT

COLLABORATION

- Microsoft Teams
- SharePoint
- Confluence
- Slack
- Jira
- Airtable
- Google Workspace

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

EDUCATION

Texas Tech University, Lubbock, TX (2008) — Bachelor of Fine Arts

CERTIFICATIONS

Senior Professional in Human Resources (sPHR), HRCI · Certified Professional in Training Management (CPTM), ATD · Google Project Management Certificate